Personal Financial Diagnostics Booklet

Part A: Your Financial Behaviour Profile

The Productivity Hacker

An action-oriented spender who pays premium prices for shortcuts and convenience, creating expensive dependency habits.

✅ Financial Strength

You take quick action, willing to find and pay for shortcuts to resolve immediate personal discomforts or academic pressure.

⚠️ Behavioural Blind Spot

Buying present comfort (e.g., expensive coffee, daily ride-shares) concentrates spending on 'convenience premiums', emptying your wallet.

⚡ Typical Risk Scenario

Trapped in a dependency loop. Once accustomed to buying time and energy, any disruption in income (e.g., losing a gig) causes your lifestyle to collapse immediately.

💡 Personalized Recommendation

Watch out for 'Dependency Spending'. Replace paid chemical boosts or ride-shares with free healthy habits like proper sleep and exercise.

Part B: Other Campus Student Archetypes

Understand common financial behavioral patterns on campus to avoid falling into the same traps:

The Balanced Strategist

A financial master who balances social life and savings by leveraging the collaborative economy and DIY alternatives.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** When faced with large unexpected expenses, you might hesitate due to over-analyzing costs or peer feelings, missing the best window to resolve the crisis.

The Cautious Socialite

A conservative planner who values relationships and avoids debt, but passively compromises in group spending.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** Passively yielding to expensive group habits gradually drains your emergency reserve in an 'unnoticed' state.

The Experience Seeker

A social enthusiast who actively hunts for discounts to maximize group fun, but lacks saving habits.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** After attending multiple orientation camps or parties, a sudden laptop breakdown or mandatory academic fee will leave you completely paralyzed.

The YOLO Spender

A highly social spender who prioritizes current vibes and connections, easily falling prey to FOMO-driven choices.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** Unable to say 'no', you max out credit cards mid-semester, forcing you to rely on high-interest loans to survive the rest of the term.

The Ambitious Optimizer

A focused achiever who leverages technology for academic efficiency, but neglects building a social support network.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** Social isolation during crises. When a real emergency hits (e.g., getting sick or needing group project support), you find yourself without a helpful network.

The Extreme Survivor

A disciplined saver who sacrifices health and social life for extreme security, risking physical and mental burnout.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** Long-term malnutrition or sleep deprivation causes a physical breakdown during mid-terms, ironically forcing high medical bills and ruining grades.

The Anxious Avoider

An overwhelmed student who passively avoids financial planning under pressure, letting small mistakes snowball into major crises.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** A minor setback (e.g., losing attendance points) triggers a butterfly effect of total avoidance, resulting in failed courses and unmanageable debt.

Part C: Universal Financial Cheat Codes for Students

No matter your archetype, these 4 low-effort micro-habits will help you effortlessly protect your wallet:

1. The Wage-Converter Hack

How it works: Next time you want to buy a $60 jacket, divide the price by your hourly part-time wage (e.g., $10/hr). Ask yourself: "Is this jacket worth standing for 6 hours serving food?" If it hurts, your brain will hit the brakes.

2. Add Digital Friction

How it works: Unlink your credit card from food delivery apps and shopping platforms. Having to physically find your card and type 16 digits when ordering late-night snacks adds enough hassle to eliminate 50% of impulse buys.

3. Lazy Tracking ("Track Big, Ignore Small")

How it works: Stop tracking every $2 drink. Only log fixed expenses and non-essential purchases over $15. Set a weekly cash budget for daily meals (e.g., $100)—when it's gone, wait until next week. Zero tracking fatigue.

4. Maximize Student Privilege

How it works: Turn asking for discounts into muscle memory. Whether buying hardware, transit passes, software, or movie tickets, always ask: "Is there a student discount?" Getting rejected costs nothing; getting a discount is risk-free arbitrage.